

HealthTech Payer Services — Medical Policy

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CONFIDENTIALITY: INTERNAL

1. Comprehensive Inpatient & Outpatient Coverage Policy

This policy defines the coverage criteria, pre-authorization guidelines, and medical necessity thresholds for inpatient and outpatient clinical procedures under HealthTech Benefit Plans.

1.1 Clinical Necessity Principles

Services are considered medically necessary only if provided in accordance with generally accepted standards of medical practice and supported by objective clinical evidence.

1.1.A Inpatient Level of Care Criteria

- **Acute Surgical Intervention:** Requires 24-hour continuous skilled nursing care post-procedure.
- **Severe Comorbidity Management:** Active management of organ system failure or high-risk systemic instability.
- **Observation Standard:** Outpatient observation status must be utilized for stays expected to be under 24 hours.

1.1.B Outpatient Surgical & Diagnostic Services

1. **Prior Authorization Requirements:** High-tech diagnostic imaging (CPT 70000–79999) requires pre-certification within 72 hours of scheduled service.
2. **Facility Setting Tiering:** Elective outpatient procedures performed in an Ambulatory Surgical Center (ASC) receive standard 100% allowed benefit; hospital-based outpatient departments require secondary medical director approval.

2. Exclusions & Limitations

Services determined to be experimental, investigational, or cosmetic are strictly non-covered unless specifically mandated by regional statutory provisions or approved via the Clinical Exception Committee (HT-PROC-001).